

Εὐπολῖς ὁ Ἀθηναῖος

Old Comedy and Athenian Politics in Eupolis

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Period: *Κλασική* [Classical](#)
Dialect: *Κωμωδία Ἀττική* [Attic Comedy](#)
Domain: *Κωμωδία* [Comedy](#)
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* [Verse](#)

Eupolis was an Athenian comic playwright of the 5th century BCE and a leading figure in Old Comedy. He was a contemporary and rival of Aristophanes. Ancient records indicate he was born around 446 BCE and won his first major dramatic competition in 429 BCE. The circumstances of his death are uncertain; a later story claims he was killed at sea by the politician Alcibiades, but many scholars consider this a legend, and he may have died in battle.

He was a prolific author, credited in antiquity with 17 plays, though only fragments of his work survive. His comedies were known for their bold political and personal satire. Notable lost plays include *The Demes*, which brought back famous Athenian statesmen from the past to critique current politics, and *The Dippers*, which mocked the controversial figure Alcibiades. Other works, like *The Flatterers*, targeted prominent intellectuals and wealthy patrons in Athenian society.

According to modern scholars, Eupolis was ranked in antiquity as one of the three great masters of Old Comedy, alongside Cratinus and Aristophanes. The fragments of his plays are crucial for understanding the full scope of the genre, revealing a tradition deeply engaged in the political debates and personalities of Athens during the Peloponnesian War. The loss of his complete works represents a significant gap in classical literature.

Works (5)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα · Athenian Life Fragments](#) · 10 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Βίου Ἀγροικοῦ · Comic Fragments on Rural Life](#) · 692 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῶν Ἀθηναίων Πολιτικῶν · Fragments on Athenian Politicians](#) · 152 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ τῆς Ἀθηναίων Κοινωνίας · Fragments on Athenian Society](#) · 77 passages
- [Ἀποσπάσματα · Pastoral and Satirical Fragments](#) · 522 passages